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Intangible Cultural Heritage

Who can do what in implementing the Convention?

Case Study 1:
Yamahoko Float Ceremony

Yamahoko float ceremony, Kyoto Gion festival (Japan)

A float decorated with tapestries is pulled through the streets while people in the floats play festival music (Kyoto Gion festival)
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- The float procession in the streets of Kyoto
- Inscribed in 2016 on the Representative List of the Intangible Cultural Heritage of Humanity as part of the file 'Yama, Hoko, Yatai, float festivals in Japan'

Yamahoko float ceremony: community-led activities (1)

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- Craftsmen work together to preserve and repair a float decorated with wooden carvings

Yamahoko float ceremony: community-led activities (2)

- Local residents participate by attending, pulling floats, playing music and performing various preparatory tasks as members of residents' associations that are responsible for the different floats
- The Foundation for Gion Festival Preservation Associations coordinates activities

Yamahoko float ceremony: government support

- Municipal government helps with logistics
- Provincial (prefectural) government funds and supports
- National government funds and creates legislative structures

Yamahoko float ceremony: other stakeholders (1)

- Local weaving and metalworking firms repair and replace necessary objects
- National Research Institute and universities undertake research

Yamahoko float ceremony: other stakeholders (2)

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- Community members plant red pine saplings to secure future materials used for the floats in a sustainable manner

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